

Motivation

Introduction

Job performance is a given requirement in any organization. It is possible, however, if the following conditions are met:

1. the capacity to perform
2. the opportunity to perform
3. the willingness to perform

The capacity to perform relates to the degree to which the employee possesses skills, abilities, knowledge, and experiences relevant to his job. If high performance is expected, the employee must be fully trained and physically capable of doing his job.

The opportunity to perform will depend on the work environment provided to the employee. One who works in an office that is hot, humid, and noisy cannot be expected to perform well. The opportunity to perform is also diminished by lack of equipment, lack of funds, and insufficient authority.

The willingness to perform relates to the degree in which an employee desires and is willing to exert effort to achieve the goals assigned to him.

The willingness to perform is also alternately called motivation.

WHAT IS MOTIVATION

People behave differently and one of the reasons is that they are motivated differently. Some are motivated by economic reasons, while some are motivated otherwise. But even those who are motivated by money will differ in terms of how much they want.

As motivation is one of the requisites of performance, a basic understanding of what motivation is and how it facilitates the achievement of goals would benefit both managers and individual employees.

Motivation may be defined as the process of activating behavior, sustaining it, and directing it toward a particular goal. Motivation moves people to act and accomplish.

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In the workplace, motivation may be more specifically defined as the set of internal and external forces that cause a worker or employee to choose a course of action and engage in a certain behavior.

KEY ELEMENTS OF MOTIVATION

Motivation consists of the following elements:

1. intensity
2. direction
3. persistence

Intensity refers to the level of effort provided by the employee in the attempt to achieve the goal assigned to him. In simple terms, intensity refers to how hard a person tries to do work.

The person's effort could be a full commitment to excellence or doing just enough to get by. For example, if a company sets a minimum output of 10 units sold per person per month, the employee whose intensity level of motivation is low will just sell 10 units per month and those with high levels of motivation would sell more.

Direction relates to what an individual chooses to do when he is confronted with a number of possible choices. When a field salesman, for instance, decided to visit a friend instead of a prospect, he is moving away from the direction his company wants him to take.

Persistence is a dimension of motivation which measures how long a person can maintain effort to achieve the organization's goals. A person who scores low in persistence gives up prematurely. An example relates to what action a salesperson will do when confronted by a prospect who thinks slowly and do not make hasty decisions. Persistence could be the answer, but the salesperson could decide otherwise.

In any case, the three elements complement each other. If the intensity of motivation is insufficient, or the effort is not properly directed or persistent enough, excellent performance is not just possible.

THEORIES OF MOTIVATION

There are various theories related to motivation. They may be classified as either (1) content, or (2) process theories.

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Content theories are those that focus on analyzing the wants and needs of an individual. The four better known content theories are the following:

1. Hierarchy of Needs Theory of Abraham Maslow
2. ERG Theory of Clayton Alderfer
3. Acquired Needs Theory of David L. McClelland
4. Two-factor Theory of Frederick Herzberg

Process theories explain how people act in response to the wants and needs that they have. Classified under process theories are the following:

1. Expectancy Theory of Victor Vroom
2. Equity Theory of J. Stacey Adams
3. Goal Setting Theory of Edwin A. Locke

The Hierarchy of Needs Theory

Abraham Maslow forwarded the idea that human beings possess a hierarchy of five needs (physiological, safety, social, esteem, and self-actualization) such that as each need is substantially satisfied, the next need becomes dominant.

A brief description of the needs is provided as follows:

1. Physiological needs - which include hunger, thirst, shelter, sex, and other bodily needs.
2. Safety needs - which include security and protection from physical and emotional harm
3. Social needs - which include affection, belongingness, acceptance, and friendship.
4. Esteem needs - which include internal esteem factors such as self-respect, autonomy, and achievement, and external esteem factors such as status, recognition, and attention.
5. Self-actualization - refers to the drive to become what one is capable of becoming, which includes growth; achieving one's potential, and self-fulfillment.

If Maslow's theory really gives clue to motivating people, managers and supervisors would do well in their jobs if they concentrate on satisfying an individual's next level of need, i.e., if the current need level is already satisfied. For instance, if an employee already feels satisfied with his

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physiological needs, then he can be expected to perform better if his safety needs are taken care of.

The ERG Theory

The ERG theory is a need hierarchy theory of motivation that was developed by Clayton Alderfer. He believed that in motivating people, we are confronted by three sets of needs: existence (E), relatedness (R), and growth (G).

These sets of needs may be briefly described as follows:

1. Existence - this refers to needs satisfied by such factors as food, air, water, pay, and working conditions;
2. Relatedness - this refers to the needs satisfied by meaningful social and interpersonal relationships; and
4. Growth - this refers to the needs satisfied by an individual making creative or productive contributions.

Alderfer, like Maslow, also believed that individuals progress up the hierarchy of needs as a result of the satisfaction of lower order needs. But he maintained, however, that if a higher order need cannot be satisfied, a lower order need becomes dominant as a motivating factor. For example, if growth cannot be attained, the individual will regress to relatedness as a motivator.

Alderfer also thought that, unlike Maslow, more than one need may be activated at the same time.

Acquired Needs Theory

Acquired needs theory was developed as a result of a research made by David McClelland and his associates. They found out that managers are motivated by three fundamental needs which may be briefly described as follows:

1. need for achievement this refers to the desire to do something better or more efficiently, to solve problems, or to master complex tasks;
2. need for affiliation - which refers to the desire to establish and maintain friendly and warm relations with others; and

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3. need for power - which refers to the desire to control others, to influence their behavior, or to be responsible for others.

McClelland believed that the foregoing needs are acquired over time as a result of life experiences.

His research findings consist of the following:

1. People who have high achievement needs have the drive to advance and to overcome challenging situations such as those faced by entrepreneurs in introducing innovative new business;
2. An affiliation motivated person prefers to work with friends;
3. The need for power drives successful managers.

The Two-factor Theory

Frederick Herzberg developed his two-factor theory that identifies job context as a source of job dissatisfaction and job content as the source of job satisfaction.

The job context or work setting relates more to the environment in which people work. The factors associated with job context are called hygiene factors which include the following:

1. organizational policies
2. quality of supervision
3. working conditions
4. base wage or salary
5. relationship with peers
6. relationship with subordinate's status
7. security

According to the two-factor theory, improving any of the hygiene factors will not make people satisfied with their work; it will only prevent them from being dissatisfied.

The job content relates more to what people actually do in their work. Those that are related to job content are called motivator factors and they consist of the following:

1. achievement

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2. recognition
3. work itself
4. responsibility
5. advancement
6. growth

According to the two-factor theory, when the foregoing factors are not present, there is low job satisfaction among workers and there is lack of motivation to perform.

Expectancy Theory

One of the process theories refer to the expectancy theory that was developed by Victor Vroom. This theory sees people as choosing a course of action according to what they anticipate will give them the greatest rewards.

Vroom elaborated by explaining that motivation is a product of the following factors:

1. valence - how much one wants a reward;
2. expectancy - one's estimate of the probability that effort will result in successful performance; and
3. instrumentality - one's estimate that performance will result in receiving the reward.

The three factors are useful in deriving motivation.

The formula is as follows:

$$\text{Valence} \times \text{Expectancy} \times \text{Instrumentality} = \text{Motivation}$$

Expectancy theory predicts that motivation will be high if all of the three factors, the lower the motivation becomes.

Equity Theory

Equity theory is the second process theory presented in this chapter. It may be defined as a theory that individuals compare job inputs and outcomes with those of others and then respond to eliminate inequities.

Equity theory assumes that employees are motivated by a desire to be equitably treated at work. Equity exists when employees perceive that the ratios of their inputs (or efforts) to their

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outputs (or rewards) are equivalent to the ratios of other employees. Inequity exists when these ratios are not equivalent.

Inequity leads to the experience of tension, and tension motivates a person to act in a manner to resolve the inequity. The person, however, will be confronted with any of the two types of inequity:

1. Over rewarded or
2. Under rewarded

Employees who feel over rewarded will think there is an imbalance in their relationship with their employer. They will seek to restore the balance through any of the following:

1. they might work harder;
2. they might discount the value of the rewards;
3. they could try to convince other employees to ask for more rewards; and
4. they might choose someone else for comparison purposes.

When employees feel under rewarded, they will seek to reduce their feelings of inequity through any of the following:

1. they might lower the quality or quantity of their productivity;
2. they could inflate the perceived value of the rewards received;
3. they could find someone else to compare themselves;
4. they could bargain for more rewards; and
5. they might quit.

Goal Setting Theory

The third process theory presented in this chapter is the goal setting theory. It may be defined as the theory that specific and difficult goals, with feedback lead to higher performance.

Goal setting theory is based on the premise that behavior is regulated by values and goals. A goal is the specific target that an individual is trying to achieve.

It was Edwin A. Locke and his associates who developed a comprehensive framework linking goals to performance. Their findings about goals include the following:

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1. Specific goals lead to a higher performance than generalized goals. For example, a specific goal like "increase sales by 10%" is more effective than a generalized goal like "increase sales".

2. Performance generally increases in direct proportion to goal difficulty. Goals that are difficult to achieve is regarded as a challenge to the ability of the person. This pushes him or her to perform. Exceptions, of course, are goals that are too difficult, and the person gets frustrated rather than inspired.

3. For goals to improve performance, they must be accepted by the workers. It is logical that when goals are accepted, workers feel that they should achieve them. Acceptance and commitment to goals happen when workers participate in the setting of goals. The workers will feel that they are "part owner" of the goals, and they will have a sense of achieving them.

4. Goals are more effective when they are used to evaluate performance. This is true especially if performance is used to determine rewards.

5. Goals should be linked to feedback. When workers receive feedback, they will know whether or not they are moving towards the direction of high performance. Such knowledge is important in maintaining the right motivation to work.

MOTIVATIONAL METHODS AND PROGRAMS

It is normal for employers to want their employees to do their best in the workplace. For employers, the ideal situation is for employees to perform excellent work, and thus produce maximum output. This is wishful thinking, however, because employees need a certain degree of motivation to perform very well. To keep employee sufficiently motivated, some means of motivation should be designed and implemented.

Four motivational methods and programs are considered in this chapter.

They are as follows:

1. motivation through job design;
2. organizational behavior modification;
3. motivation through recognition and pride; and
4. motivation through financial incentives.

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Motivation through Job Design

One way of motivating employees is to make their job challenging so that the worker who is responsible for it enjoys doing it. This management activity is called job design, when it is undertaken; some useful benefits will accrue to the organization.

Job design may be defined as the way the elements in a job are organized

Three concepts are important in designing jobs. They consist of the following:

1. job enrichment
2. job characteristics model
3. job crafting

Job Enrichment

This term refers to the practice of building motivating factors like responsibility, achievement and recognition into job content. Job enrichment provides the worker with a more exciting job and it increases his job satisfaction and motivation.

An enriched job has any or all of the following characteristics:

1. Direct feedback which means employees receive immediate evaluation of their work.
2. Client relationships - which means an employee is given a chance to serve an external or internal client.
3. New learning - which means that the employee acquires new knowledge while doing his work.
4. Control over method - which means that the employee has some control over which method to choose to accomplish a task.
5. Control over scheduling - which means the employee has the ability to schedule his work.
6. Unique experience which means the job has unique qualities or features, like the opportunity to see the world.

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7. Direct communication authority which means the job provides the employee the opportunity to communicate directly with people who use their output.
8. Control over resources which means the employee has some control over resources such as money, material, or people.
9. Personal accountability - which means the employee is responsible for his or her result. He accepts credits for doing a good job, and blame for a poor job.

Job Characteristics Model

This term refers to the method of job design that focuses on the task and interpersonal demands of a job. This method emphasizes the interaction between the individual and the specific attributes of the job.

The job characteristics theory maintains that there are five core job characteristics of special importance to job design. When these core job characteristics are high, the job is said to be enriched,

The five core job characteristics are defined as follows:

1. Skill variety - the degrees to which there are many skills to perform. An example of a job scoring high on skill variety would be the master carpenter who makes and install doors, door jambs, cabinets, wooden floors, tables, chairs, toys, upholstery, and the like. An example of a job scoring low on skill variety is the worker who installs bricks eight hours a day.
2. Task identity - the degree to which one worker is able to do a complete job, from beginning to end, with the tangible and possible outcome. An example of a job scoring high on identity would be a guitar maker who designs the product, select the materials builds the object and finishes it to be a fine musical instrument. A job scoring low on the task identity dimension would be a person whose job is solely to play the electric bass in a live band performance.
3. Task significance the degree to which the job has a substantial impact on the lives or work of other people. An example of a job scoring high on task significance would be a close-in bodyguard who protects the president of a nation. A job scoring low on this dimension would be a dishwasher in a restaurant.

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4. Autonomy - the degree which the job gives the employee substantial freedom, independence, and discretion in scheduling the work and determining the procedures used in carrying it out. An example of a job scoring high on autonomy is a bus inspector who schedules his or her own work and decides on the most effective means of checking the work of drivers and conductors assigned to him or her. A job scoring low on autonomy would be a bank teller who is required to follow a standardized procedure with each bank client.

5. Feedback the degree to which a job provides direct information about performance. An example of a job with high feedback is an electrician who installs electric wirings at residences and then tests them for the homeowner to see if they operate properly. A job scoring low on feedback would be a university professor who receives performance feedback many months after handling a class.

Job Crafting

This refers to the physical and mental changes workers make in the task or relationship aspect of their jobs.

The common types of job crafting are:

1. changing the number and type of job tasks;
2. changing the interaction with others on the job; and
3. changing one's view of the job.

Organizational Behavior Modification

The second method of motivation is called organizational behavior modification (OB Mod). It is actually the application of reinforcement theory in motivating people at work.

Reinforcement theory may be briefly defined as the contention that behavior is determined by its consequences. Simply stated, a person tends to repeat behavior that is accompanied by favorable consequences and tends not to repeat behavior that is accompanied by unfavorable consequences.

The typical OB Mod program consists of a five-step problem- solving model. These are as follows:

1. *Identifying critical behaviors* that make a significant impact on the employee's job performance;

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2. *Developing baseline data* which is obtained by determining the number of times the identified behavior is occurring under present conditions;
3. *Identifying behavioral consequences* of performance;
4. *Developing and implementing an intervention strategy* to strengthen desirable performance behaviors and weaken undesirable behaviors; and
5. *Evaluating performance improvement.*

Among the benefits of OB Mod are:

1. improvement of employee productivity;
2. reduction of errors, absenteeism, tardiness, and accident rates; and
3. improvement of friendliness toward customers.

Motivation through Recognition and Pride

Recognition is a natural human need and it is a strong motivator. To make it an effective motivator, the following steps are necessary:

1. Identify a meritorious behavior (for example, the development of a scheme that reduces the cost of providing service to customers); and
2. Recognize the behavior with an oral, written, or material reward. For example, the equivalent of 10% of the cost savings will be given to the worker who developed the scheme every time the savings is realized.

For a better understanding and implementation of reward and recognition programs, the following points must be considered:

1. Feedback is an essential part of recognition;
2. Praise is one of the most powerful forms of recognition
3. Reward and recognition programs should be limited to organizational goals;
4. Identification of the type of rewards and recognition that the workers will value; and
5. It is important to evaluate the effectiveness of the reward and recognition program.

Pride is also a motivator, but one that is intrinsic. Workers who achieve outstanding performance experience the emotion of pride. The feeling satisfies the need for self-esteem and self-fulfillment. This provides managers with a clue on what concrete actions could be done to motivate workers.

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Motivation through Financial Incentives

Financial incentives are powerful tools of motivation. They are monetary rewards paid to employees because of the output they produce, skills, knowledge, and competencies or a combination of these factors.

Financial incentives take the form of any or a combination of the following:

1. time rates
2. payment by results
3. performance and profit related pay
4. skill/competency-based pay
5. cafeteria or flexible benefits system

Each of the foregoing financial incentives offers unique advantages although there are also some disadvantages when they are used to motivate employees.

Time Rates

This type of monetary reward use the number of hours worked as a means of determining rewards. It may be classified as hourly rate, or weekly wage, or a monthly salary.

The advantages of time rates are as follows:

1. It is open to inspection and equitable because employees doing the same job will be on the same grade level.
2. It encourages the retention of human resources by stability and this is because of the gradual increases in rewards within the given grades.
3. It is relatively easy to administer and allows labor cost to be predicted.
4. It does not emphasize quantity of output to the detriment of quality.

The main disadvantage of time rates is that it does not motivate employees to become more productive.

Payment by Results

This scheme links pay to the quantity of the individual's output. An example is the commission paid to a salesman for selling the company's products.

The advantages of payment by results are the following:

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1. The employee is motivated to put in extra effort because by doing so, he or she will receive additional income;
2. There is fairness because the level of reward is related to the level of output; and
3. There are likely to be cost advantages since wages are directly linked to production and less supervision is required.

The disadvantages of payment by results are as follows:

1. Outputs in certain jobs cannot be easily measured;
2. Safety standards may be compromised. For instance, the high rate of accidents involving bus drivers who are paid commissions is sufficient proof of the disadvantage of payment by results; and
3. Workers may view payment by results as a device to obtain greater effort from them without commensurate rewards.

Performance Related Pay

This scheme considers results or output plus actual behavior in the job. Most often, rewards consist of a lump sum, or a bonus as a percentage of basic salary, with quality of performance determining the magnitude of the percentage increase, or alternatively accelerated movement up a pay scale. The bonus is a reward given to employees for recent performance rather than historical performance.

The advantages of performance related pay are as follows:

1. It increases employee beliefs (instrumentality) that reward will follow high performance;
2. Those that perform better are rewarded more; and
3. It is comparatively objective and verifiable.

The disadvantages are as follows:

1. cost rises along with the rewards;
2. the system is complex;
3. employees with declining energy may experience a decrease in total pay;
4. the union may resist the incentive idea;
5. there is delay in the payment of incentives;
6. the system is rigid; and
7. it is difficult to motivate higher performance across a broad range of employees.

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Profit Related Pay

This is an organization wide scheme where pay is linked to company profits. Profit related pay takes the form of direct cash outlay, or allocation of stock options.

Stock option is a financial incentive that gives employees the right to purchase a certain number of company shares at a specified price, generally the market price of the stock on the day the option is granted.

The following are the advantages of profit related pay:

1. Employees identify more closely with the success of the organization;
2. There is a breaking down or removal of the communication barrier between management and employees;
3. Cooperation and working together for mutual benefit is encouraged;
4. Awareness of the link between performance and organizational profitability leads to a greater awareness of costs and their impact on performance;
5. When profits fall, the decline in pay is a preferable alternative to laying off employees; and
6. Group pressure could raise the performance levels of poor performers.

The disadvantages of profit related pay are as follows:

1. Profits are not directly related to an employee's effort on the job, and this is a negative factor on motivation;
2. Employees must wait for their reward, and the delay diminishes its impact; and
3. Since profits are unpredictable, total worker income may vary from year to year. As a result, some workers may prefer the stability of a fixed wage or salary.

Skill Based Pay

Also known as competency based or knowledge-based pay, this is a pay plan that sets pay levels on the basis of how many skills employees have or how many jobs they can do:

The advantages of the skill-based pay are the following:

1. It provides strong motivation for employees to develop their work-related skills;
2. It reinforces an employee's sense of self-esteem; and
3. It provides the organization with a highly flexible workforce that can fill in when someone is absent.

The disadvantages are as follows:

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1. Since most employees will voluntarily learn higher-level jobs, the average hourly pay rate will be greater than normal;
2. A substantial investment in employee training must be made especially in the time spent coaching by supervisors and peers;
3. Not all employees like skill-based pay because it places pressure on them to move up the skill ladder; and
4. Some employees will qualify themselves for skill areas that they will unlikely use, causing the organization to pay them higher rates than they deserve.

Cafeteria or Flexible Benefit System

This is a benefit plan that allows each employee to put together a benefit package individually tailored to his or her own needs and situation. Examples of benefits that may be included in the plan are health and life insurance company car, additional holiday entitlement, membership to social clubs, modification of working hours, special pension arrangement, mortgage loan subsidies, and others.

The advantages of this plan are as follows

1. It enables employees to choose options that best fit their own needs. Old workers, for instance, may choose health and life insurance, while the younger ones may choose membership to social clubs.
2. Deciding among the various options makes employees more aware of the benefits, giving them a real sense of the value of the benefits their employers provide.
3. Flexible benefit plans can lower compensation costs because employers no longer have to pay for unwanted benefits.
4. Employers and employees can save on taxes.

The disadvantages of the plan are as follows:

1. It creates an administrative burden
2. It can lead to the increased insurance premiums.

Summary

Employee performance is a very important concern for people running organizations. One of the requirements of performance is motivation.

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Motivation may be defined as the process of activating behavior, sustaining it, and directing it toward a particular goal. persistence. The various theories of motivation may be categorized.

The key elements of motivation are intensity, direction, and as either content or process theories. Content theories are those that focus on analyzing the wants and needs of an individual. Process theories explain how people act in response to the wants and needs that they have.

The better-known content theories are: hierarchy of needs theory, ERG theory, acquired needs theory, and two-factor theory. The better-known process theories are: expectancy theory, equity theory, and goal setting theory.

Workers may be motivated through any of the following methods and programs: job design, organizational behavior modification, recognition and pride, and financial incentives.

Assessment

Answer the following questions in a separate sheet of paper. Submit to your teacher via google classroom email or messenger.

File name should be [Surname/Activity 6/Leadership in Organization]
ex. **Dela Cruz Activity 6 Leadership in Organization**

1. What conditions make job performance possible in any organization?
2. What motivates people to behave differently?
3. How may one define intensity as an element of motivation?
4. What does Abraham Maslow espouse in his hierarchy of needs theory?
5. According to David McClelland, what motivates people?
6. What is the two-factor theory?
7. Under the equity theory, when does equity exist?
8. In what way does job design motivate people?
9. What does the OB Med program consist of?
10. What is the nature of profit related pay?

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